

Vitamins

In addition to providing fuel for your body, food contains the 13 vitamins that are vital to health. You need only tiny amounts, but vitamins keep you looking good and feeling fine—going without them can damage your health and cause nasty diseases.

WOW!

Not all vitamins come from food. Vitamin D is vital for bone growth. One form of it is made by your skin when it is exposed to sunlight.

WHAT ARE VITAMINS?

Each vitamin is a complex natural chemical that has a special job in the body. Vitamins are known by a letter of the alphabet, and sometimes a number. Ascorbic acid, for example, is usually called vitamin C, and riboflavin is vitamin B2. You get vitamins from certain foods in your diet.



CHICKEN FEED

In the past, many people in Southeast Asia died from a wasting disease called beriberi. In the 1890s, Dutch doctor Christiaan Eijkman found that chickens fed only white rice got the same disease, but those given brown rice were healthy. The brown rice contained vitamin B1, which prevented beriberi.

Dairy products, such as milk, are full of vitamin A.

Leafy greens, such as cabbage and spinach, contain vitamin K.

Citrus fruits are a good source of vitamin C.

Eggs are a good source of B vitamins.

Chicken and other meats contain B vitamins.

Wheat germ contains vitamin E.

